
1. Feature Overview

Description (The “What”)

[What is the feature’s overall purpose and value? What is the problem it solves for the business?]

The **Membership Model Definition** project serves as the critical foundational layer for a modern, AI-first membership solution built on the Salesforce platform. It automates the end-to-end journey from member acquisition to financial reconciliation by providing the necessary integration layers to unify disparate products—including membership tier definition and member tracking(Loyalty), high-conversion storefronts (Commerce), and rigid accounting ledgers (Revenue Cloud)—into a single, seamless user experience.

Business Case (The “Why”)

[Why to invest in this feature now - Product strategy, V2MOM alignment, Customer asks (VoC or Idea Exchange), partner insights, SE/AE field feedback, GTM team observations]

- **Primary Business Motivation: Expand TAM** by entering a new market with **\$7.3B TAM**
- **Why Now**
 - Challenging Fundraising Environment - Memberships offer reliable, recurring revenue for financial stability- which is what nonprofits are investing in right now
 - Legacy Systems Are Dated - Market is ready for disruption beyond static, dated solutions.
 - Unhappy Customers, Partners & AEs - Existing solutions have high costs and do not fully meet all needs. Partners are continually asking us, when are you building membership? (Not if)
 - Incentive to Migrate - Our legacy managed package NPSP has basic membership functionality. Adding it in core will provide a place for data to migrate to as well as an added carrot as add our intelligence and AI layer
- **Why Us**

- True Supporter 360 - Competitors integrate with a CRM. Whereas we are the CRM- unifying membership, giving, and volunteering into a single, Supporter 360.
- Platform Advantage - Membership organizations the security, customizability and integration tools that come with a platform. The platform also gives us the tools to create a truly proactive, personalized member experience, which competitors struggle with. A differentiator for us
- Sticky Cross Cloud Deals - The solution here will be a cross cloud play, creating sticky customers
- Right to Play - Leverage existing market traction and convert opportunistic wins into market leadership. These won opportunities give us the right to play. Customers expect us to be in this market
- Accelerate Through Reuse - Time to market accelerated by Agentforce Nonprofit, RLM, Sales and Commerce & other industry solutions. We can become highly competitive in the space quickly.

Job Personas (The “Who”) and Key Jobs

[Who are the primary users of this feature? Describe the key jobs in the JTBD format.

New to JTBD? Check out [JTBD for TMP](#) and [Industries](#).]

What is Membership Management?

- A membership organization is an entity that cultivates and manages a dedicated base of supporters -called members- by delivering exclusive value, shared experiences, and mission-aligned programs that foster long-term member engagement and provide sustainable revenue to the organization.
- Membership management is the strategic process of coordinating the entire member lifecycle—from enrollment and billing to personalized engagement—to ensure long-term retention and growth.
- Examples of Membership organizations:
 - Professional Associations (e.g., AARP, American Medical Association)
 - Clubs, Gyms, or Community Centers (e.g., YMCAs, Boys & Girls Clubs, JCCs)
 - Cultural Institution or Visitor Attraction (e.g., San Diego Zoo, San Francisco Museum of Modern Art, Monterey Bay Aquarium)
 - Advocacy or Mission-Based Membership Organizations (e.g., The Sierra Club, NPR, St Johns Presbyterian Church)

Membership Director

- The Membership Director is a hybrid leader responsible for the financial sustainability of the organization through the cultivation of a loyal, engaged community. They bridge the gap between "Guest Services" (hospitality) and "The Front Office" (business strategy). They solve the "One-and-Done" churn problem by turning transactional visitors into transformational advocates. They win when they can use data to prove that the organization isn't just a "discount club," but a vital community.
 - **JTBD:**
 - **Strategic Job:** Prove that our mission is a 'must-have' subscription in a world of 'nice-to-have' discounts.
 - **Emotional:** Make me feel confident that we have a predictable, sustainable income stream that isn't dependent on one-off grants.
 - **Operational Jobs:**
 - Eliminate the friction between a member's desire to support us and the technology required to do so.
 - Help me identify members at risk of churning before their renewal date so I can intervene.
 - Orchestrate the 'supporter journey' so we don't over-solicit or under-serve our most loyal people.
- Detail - [Membership Director](#)
 - [Persona cards](#)
 - Detailed JTBD-  JTBD- Membership & Associations- DRAFT 2026

Member

- The Member is a stakeholder who invests their time, money, and identity into the organization. They are looking for a "Return on Relationship." While their tangible needs differ by organization type (credentials vs. gym access vs. admission), their core human desire remains the same: **to be recognized for their loyalty and to have a frictionless, high-value experience.**
 - **JTBD**
 - **Functional (The Access):** "Help me use what I pay for (CEUs, gym lanes, or exhibit entry) instantly without administrative hurdles."
 - **Emotional (The Recognition):** "Recognize my tenure and contribution so I feel like a partner in the mission, not a stranger at the gate."
 - **Social (The Network):** "Provide me with a community of like-minded peers or a safe space for my family to grow."
- Detail - [Member](#)
 - [Persona cards](#)
 - Detailed JTBD -  JTBD- Membership & Associations- DRAFT 2026

Scope

[Specify what is in scope, what is out of scope? Specify the rollout strategy - GA / Beta / Pilot]

Rollout Strategy

GA alongside lighthouse customers. Potential to add a pilot depending on timing. GA timing pending allocation of engineering resources

In-Scope (Foundational Layer)

The initial focus is on a foundational layer designed to get all membership organizations started, regardless of their specific archetype.

- **Membership Model Definition:** Core tools to define tiers (Individual, Household, Corporate, Student), term types (Anniversary vs. Calendar), and benefits.
- **Member Tracking:** Centralized member lifecycle management, including status tracking, membership history, and benefit entitlement mapping.
- **Revenue & Billing Basics:** Foundational pricing, automated invoicing, and renewals
- **Core Automation:** such as standardized renewals and status automation and basic payment failure workflows to maintain financial continuity.
- **Connective Tissue Between Solutions:** Ensure a good user experience and reasonable implementation costs when blending together Loyalty, Commerce, Revenue Clouds and as well as Salesforce Payments

Out-of-Scope For this PRD

This PRD lays the foundation for more advanced AI agents, analytics, and a Slack-first user experience. Additionally, this PRD does not include speciality features needed primarily for one membership organization archetype.

2. User Experience & Functional Requirements

Research Insights / Compete

[Optional, but recommended for major capabilities or new product areas.

Consider including competitive research, design partner insights, or comparable features built by other Salesforce clouds.]

R&I

- Membership Director Interview [Notebook](#)
- Membership Director Interview Readout:
 - ☐ Agentic Membership Mgmt.:Phase 1:Discovery:March 2026
- Membership Director Survey Readout:
 - ☐ Membership Mgmt: Survey Results: Jan-Feb 2026
- Finance Team Research:
 - ☐ Finance dept.'s Intersections across Nonprofit Teams_Feb 2026

Competitive

- ☐ Associations & Membership Opportunity Assessment
- <https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1q2SiE1ylkcO5JJmal7c0C85-j0kyGxNY28Ub3Nr5m2E/edit?gid=0#gid=0>

User Journey Or Flow Diagram (WIP)

[Optional. Provide a high-level operational flow (blocks-and-arrows) showing how users move through the feature. This is not a technical sequence diagram. A first-cut sketch from a whiteboard session, customer call, or prior release is sufficient to align UX and architecture teams during early planning.]

UX Mocks (WIP)

[UX-owned artifacts. PMs link documents here as they become available during advanced planning.]

- Owner: UX Lead
- Link: *Paste link when available*
- Status: *Draft / In Review / Approved*

Userstories And Acceptance Criteria

[User Stories are composed of “who”, “what” and “why” - they explain the roles of Users in a Salesforce system, their desired activities and what they intend to accomplish. They're used to guide the team's thinking on necessary feature sets, features, components or automations because they communicate the wants and needs of the end user.]

Membership Model Definition

	Userstory	Acceptance Criteria	Priority
	As a Membership Director, I want to create multiple membership tiers , so that I can begin executing our membership strategy	Each tier the following basic attributes: 1. Tier Name (eg Gold/Silver/Bronze or Student/Member/Retired) 2. Tier Type (Individual, Household/Family/Corporate) 3. Tier Description (text) 4. Term Type (eg calendar year vs anniversary start date + 365) 5. Number of members included (eg 2 adults, 15 employees) a. Option to define if these seats are named or unnamed (eg for John Doe and Guest, or Jane & John Doe) 6. Visibility (public and anyone can join vs. private/invite only) 7. Eligibility rules (if any, eg must be over 65, have a student email address, have X professional credential)	
	As a Membership Director, I want to define a pricing and renewal strategy for our membership tiers , so that I can establish a sustainable revenue source	Each tier has the follow pricing & renewal attributes 1. Base price (how much does the tier cost when not discounted). Price can be \$0. 2. Price duration (eg one month, one year) 3. Fair Market Value (what is the value of the membership so any tax-deductible donation amount can be calculated) 4. Renewal Window Length (how many days before member's membership expires can they renew) 5. Grace Period (how many days after a member's membership end date do they retain member status before they lapse) 6. Pro rating rules (eg if you cancel 50% through membership period do you get money back)	

	As a Membership Director, I want to track what benefits each member tier includes, so that I can deliver exclusive value to our members	Each tier can be associated with many benefits and benefits may be of many types including Effective Dates to track when a benefit was included/removed from a tier. The same benefit can be offered to many tiers. Benefits can be capped or limited (eg only used per free admission once in a day). Set Benefit redemption time frames. Eg always aligned to membership term or can be different. Example: Membership expires on 12/31/26. Today is 12/24/26 and I still have 2 free tickets. Admn can configure if I should be allowed to place an order on 12/24 for a date on 1/1/27 or later? Types of benefits - Free admission (eg 2 adults, 2 kids free at each visit) - Guest tickets or passes - Discounts (eg reduced fee at the cafe or store or on conference registration) - Physical Items (eg tote bag, hat) - Content (eg webinars, white papers, trainings) - Voting Rights (esp for professional associations) - Event invitations (eg members only appreciation night)	
	As a Membership Director, I want to see key details about each member, so I can understand their status and engagement	Assumption: Individual people are represented as person accounts. Businesses are business accounts. On each member record I can see and update: - Membership Type - Membership Tier - Membership Status (eg active, lapsed,suspended) - Unique Member ID/Code - Membership Term Start Date - Membership Term End Date (aka Renewal Date) - Price paid for current membership - Action taken to arrive at current membership level (e.g. New, Renewal, Upgrade, Downgrade) - Lifetime membership spend	

		- Member Since Date (first membership date) - Lifetime membership months (calculated as the number of months the person has been an active member - excludes any lapsed periods) - Highest Member Level Achieved - Primary Member Name (eg person or company who purchased membership and made them a member) - Household Members - Member Interests (eg Interest tags) - Communication preferences - Credential Status (eg has active professional credential required for membership) - Continuing education credits earned - Donation History - Volunteer history	
	As a Membership Director, I want to see renewal and billing info for each member , so I can remind and troubleshoot as needed	For each member I can see and update: - Payment Method (eg check, cash, credit card) - Payment Details (eg credit card information) - Billing Status - Billing & Payment History - Auto-renew opt in status - Outstanding Revenue for the individual member (\$600 remaining, will decrease by \$100 on first of the month for next six months until all revenue recognized)	
	As a Membership Director, I want to see track a members activity including benefits used , so I can understand their status and engagement	For each member I can see: - What member benefits they have access to - What member benefits they have used - Show recap - Total Available Benefits - Total Benefits Redeemed - Remaining Available Benefits - Member activity with the organization outside of member benefits (eg donations, program engagement, visits, volunteering) - Unified timeline of member activity - Household member activity and benefit usage	

	As a Membership Director, I want to track corporate memberships , so I can solidify this revenue sources	For each corporate member I can see and update: - Who the primary point of contact is - How many memberships they have access to - Track a specific list of people - Track a fixed number of memberships / membership cards. Cards are "checked out" by staff virtually or physically. These members usually just show up and present the card. - Track a certain number of admissions per day. The amount resets for the next day. Usually there will be a portal for the individual to reserve a ticket using the corporate account. - How many are being used - Who the associated members are - Activity & benefit usage of associated members - Transfer membership to a new staff person if current member leaves/changes position	
	As a Membership Director, I want reports for tracking my member base , so I can monitor our progress	Example basic reports: - Email / Mailing list of individual members by status - Email / Mailing list of member households by status - Members by tier and status - Members by upcoming renewal date and renewal status - Members in grace period before lapsing - Members who have used no benefits - Members who have used/not used X benefit (a specific benefit) - Member dues by Tier last year - Member dues by tier expected next 3 months - Member Lifetime Value LTV (all time dues + non dues revenue + donations) (We won't ship these but should be used to vet data model)	
	As the SI Partner/Admin, I can quickly turn on automation for common use cases , so that both implementation costs and manual workflows are kept to a minimum	General Workflows - Status Transitions: When does a member transition from "Active" to "Grace Period" to "Lapsed"? Need flexible tools to clearly define automated time-based lifecycle phases for moving from one status to the next	

		- Benefit Provisioning: Reset available benefits at the beginning of a new member term or if a member upgrades (eg if guest passes were used last year and they get 2 passes each year, reset value to 2 at beginning of new year) - Benefit Versioning: If benefits in a tier change, how does that roll out to existing members. Does everyone get new perks immediately? Or do existing members get grandfathered in to old benefits until new membership term starts? - Automatic Member Assignment: Automatically add or remove someone to a membership level based on criteria, including gift type and calendar/fiscal year (eg major donors with gift over 10k get automatic one year membership at X level) - Corporate Member Sign Ups: If a new member joins who is part of a corporate member, automatically associate the accounts and billing - Early Renewals: Need to prevent the member from using benefits associated with the new membership until the new term begins.	
	As a membership director, I want our membership management tools to be easy to use , so I can be confident and efficient doing my job		
	As a SI Partner/Admin, I want our membership management tools to be straightforward to set up , so implementation costs aren't prohibitively high		
	As a membership director, I want easily issue digital membership cards to members, so they can gain the access they need without keeping track of a physical card	Ability to automate issuing a digital member card or QR code Ability to add digital member card to a digital wallet	

Billing & Revenue Management

	Userstory	Acceptance Criteria	Priority
	As a Membership Director and Finance Director, we want automated revenue recognition tools , so we can handle complex recurring billing use cases and reconciliation with less manual work	- Ability to define revenue recognition rules by product type (membership, event, sponsorship, bundle) (eg what percentage of each membership fee counts as revenue in each month) - Ability to automatically defer and recognize revenue over time based on membership terms or milestones - Ability to generate recognition schedules and handle mid-cycle changes (refunds, upgrades, cancellations) - Ability to produce compliant revenue recognition reports aligned with accounting standards - Ability to manage instant rev recognition and deferred rev rec from the same transaction (eg if a book and a membership are purchased at the same time)	
	As a Membership Director, I want to manage our payment system , so we can efficiently collect member dues	Payment Management - Ability to manage recurring membership billing based on billing schedules, membership terms, and renewal preferences - Create & apply full or partial dues waiver (eg to manually assign a membership level without payment) - Create payment/installment plans and determine when membership is considered active in the plan (eg does membership start when full balance is paid or when payment plan begins) - Ability to manage billing hierarchies (eg a corporate employer to receive a single consolidated invoice for all of their participating employees' memberships)	
	As a Membership Director, I want to manage invoices , so we can efficiently collect member dues	Invoice Management - Set rules on when invoices are generated - Ability to generate invoice - Ability to include FMV vs donation amount on invoice - Ability to manage credits, adjustments, and refunds	

		- Ability to generate aging reports in case of pending payments	
	As a Membership Director, I want to process & record member payments, so we can efficiently collect member dues	Payment Processing - Ability to process one time payments, recurring payments and renewals of recurring payments - Ability to process membership dues and other payments in the same cart - Ability to apply member specific discounts at checkout - Payment types - Ability to process credit and debit cards - Ability to support ACH and bank transfers - Ability to support payment by cash or check - Ability to accept digital wallets (PayPal, Venmo, Apple/Google Pay) - Ability to support stored payment methods - Ability to assign and charge appropriate taxes based on member location - Ability to support zero dollar check out transactions. eg organizations process the redemption of free member perks (like free admission or free attraction access) as \$0 purchases - (P2) Ability to capture offline payments - (P2) Ability to support international currencies and cross-border payments	
	As a membership director, I want to set conditional pricing and proration rules so we can quickly adjust member dues for different scenarios	- The pricing engine should support formula-based rules. For example, the system should be able to automatically adjust a membership's price based on an attribute on the account, such as the organization's annual budget or the member's age. - Proration Management: The system needs rules to calculate prorated costs for members joining mid-cycle, with flexibility to configure this proration on a daily, weekly, monthly, or quarterly basis (eg If their membership runs on a calendar year and a new member joins Oct 1, what portion of the annual fee should they pay?)	

	As a Membership Director, I want to offer merchandise sales so we can get additional non dues revenue.	- Ability to sell products & merchandise on marketplace to constituents - Ability to purchase products or merchandise in the same cart as a membership	
	As a Membership Director, I want create promotions and connect them to campaigns , so I can attract more members with unique offers	Example promotions - x% Discount on membership fee - \$10 off membership fee - First month free - Free gift with paid membership at X tier	
	As a Membership Director, I want create bundles, cross sell and upsell opportunities , so I can deepen wallet share with members	Example bundles - Membership + event registration - Sponsorship package Example cross sell/upsell - A museum member uses their special exhibit entry pass, receives notification “ while you’re here, use your 20% off at gift shop” - A member of a professional association registers for a free webinar and get automatically offered the early bird discount on the annual conference	
	As the SI Partner/Admin, I can quickly turn on automation for common use cases , so that both implementation costs and manual workflows are kept to a minimum	- Renewals: when does renewal period start, invoice creation and delivery, what reminders are sent - Payment Failure & Expiring Credit Cards: what happens when a payment fails or a credit card is about to reach expiration date - Upgrade/downgrade/cancel billing adjustment: how is billing adjusted when membership tier is change - Fair Market Value Calculation: when a membership is sold track what portion is the member fee (goods & services) and what portion is a tax-deductible donation so tax receipt can be produced if needed - GL Mapping: All transactions are automatically transformed such that they can be processed by accounting system - Refund Logic: Refund policies should be configurable by payment type (e.g., ensuring a credit card payment is	

		refunded directly to the original card, not issued as a cash refund)	
	As a membership director, I want our revenue management tools to be easy to use , so I can be confident and efficient doing my job		
	As a SI Partner/Admin, I want our revenue management tools to be straightforward to set up , so implementation costs aren't prohibitively high		

To Be Completed After Eng Tech Design Begins

Licensing

[Define how the feature is made available to customers by specifying the required org-level settings, user permissions, and licensing model that control access and entitlement]

Considerations

- Org Preference
- Org Permission / User Permission
- Add-on License / SKU Dependency
- Provisioning and Upgrade

Dependencies

[Describe any dependencies that impact this effort. Include technical and business dependencies.]

- File Team Dependencies in GUS. Here are sample guides from Industries:
 - [Step-by-Step Guide for Logging Team Dependencies on Industries Cloud](#)

- [Industries Team Dependency \(TD\) Template](#)

Risks

[Describe any risks that impact this effort. Include technical and business risks and define a mitigation plan for each.]

- Business Risks: *To be completed by Product Manager*
- Technical Risks: *To be completed by Engineering Lead*

Test Strategy

[Describe a high level test plan approach for functional testing and performance testing.]

CX Requirements

[Describe any important context or details that need to be addressed when documenting the epic, including any existing sections that need to be revised.]

- Release Note(s)
- UI Text
- Setup help documentation
- API developer documentation
 - Sample Code in Dev Docs where needed
- Trailhead
- Video
- Other (please describe)

3. Non-Functional Requirements (NFRs)

Instrumentation / Telemetry

[Define the list of business and usage metrics that must be instrumented to measure feature adoption and success criteria. Include PFT logging requirements.]

Performance & Scalability Goals

[Define the expected latency, concurrent users, expected TPS, data volume needs etc.,]

Reliability, availability, maintainability

[How often does the system experience critical failures? and how much time is available to users against downtimes? Backward compatibility needs? Deployment scenarios?]

Security

[How are the system and its data protected against attacks?]

Localization

[Does the system match local specifics?]

Compliance (Regulated Environments)

[Identify the regulatory obligations (HIPAA, GDPR, etc,) Gov Cloud certification and the system capabilities required to produce audit evidence and meet validation and data-handling requirements.]

4. Architecture & Design

ACD / Design Doc

[Engineering and architecture-owned artifacts. PMs link documents here as they become available during advanced planning.]

- Owner: Engineering Architect / Engineering Lead
- Link: *Paste link when available*
- Status: *Draft / In Review / Approved*

5. References

[Supporting Links / Artifacts]

 Agentic Membership Management Resource Overview- 2026